WAR STORIES

OTTO CARIUS

Eastern Front
German Army
November 1943



Military Decorations:

September 15, 1942
Iron Cross second class

November 23, 1943
Iron Cross first class

May 4, 1944
Knight's Cross of the Iron Cross

July 27, 1944
Knight's Cross of the Iron Cross with Oak leaves

September 11, 1944
Wound Badge (gold color) and Panzer Badge (silver color) for at least 100 engagements in armored vehicles.

Prussian hussars in the age of Frederick the Great sported the Skull-and-Bones (Totenkopf) symbol which also adorned the collars of Wehrmacht and Luftwaffe Panzer troops in World War II. Panzer personnel is therefore confounded with SS units who had adopted the same emblem overall.

Otto Carius

Born on May 27 in 1922 at Zweibrücken.

Who could have predicted that a timid and scrawny boy like Otto Carius would eventually become one of the biggest Panzerwaffe aces, credited with an exceptional tally of 150 victories.

He studies engineering, whilst also being a gifted piano and violin player.

At the start of the war, he wants to enlist but is considered unfit for duty due to being underweight and puny.

Finally, during the Spring of 1940, he is allowed to join the infantry, unfortunately being regarded as the laughing stock of his unit. Small wonder he swiftly volunteers for the Panzer units as soon as his company commander mentions such a potential transfer.

After completing the proper drill, he serves on the Eastern Front as a loader in the 20. Panzer Division.

In August 1941, he returns to Germany to try his hand at being a tank driver and to obtain an officer's brevet. He fails to succeed and is consequently sent back to the Eastern Front in February 1942, spending the rest of that year in intense defensive battles but securing a promotion to Reserve Lieutenant in early 1943. Whilst on leave in Germany, he is selected for training with the all-new Tiger tank. Starting July 21st 1943, as part of the 2. Schwere Panzer-Abteilung 502 close to Leningrad, Otto Carius' legend gradually begins to take shape.

In 1951, he is running his very own *Tiger-Apotheke* (the Tiger Pharmacy).

IN THE CLAWS OF THE BEAST

Newel, November 1943:
Ever since their deployment in the Leningrad sector, the Tiger-Abteilung 502 is drawn into horrific battles of attrition. The Germans fail to gain the upper hand, despite the numerous victories being amassed by Otto Carius and the Tigers as the Soviets keep throwing ever better weapons and seasoned troops into the fray.
At the end of November, the 2. Kompanie must keep the Welikie Luki-Newel-Vitebsk road open to allow the infantry to take up new defensive positions.

RECRUITMENT OF THE ARMIES

ELEMENTS OF THE 2ND SHOCK ARMY



ELEMENTS OF THE 2. KOMPANIE SCHWERE PANZER-ABTEILUNG 502



SPECIAL SCENARIO RULES

Battle of the tanks!

All Action Cards of the German and Russian decks are applicable to **Heavy Vehicles** even if their texts normally limit their use to other types of units. Each mention to one or more types of units is replaced by **Heavy Vehicle**.

Note: Some cards remain unusable because their Battle Event is incompatible with the rules applying to Heavy Vehicles. Discard such cards in the Supply Phase and draw new ones.

Scenario Requirements
Core Box: Heroes of Stalingrad



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BATTLEFIELD



PREPARATION



- The **Russian** player has the **Initiative**.
- The **Russian** player deploys first.
- The **German** player deploys next.
- Each player draws **3 Action Cards**.
- The game lasts **8 Turns**.



VICTORY CONDITIONS

DESTROY 3 T-34 TANKS

DESTROY THE TIGER TANK

EPILOGUE

Whilst his unit is on the move, Carius falls behind, forced to stop due to problems with the left track of his tank.
As Köstler, the driver, starts the repairs, the tank commander scouts the surrounding area with his binoculars, soon spotting a dozen enemy tanks in the far distance.
Since the German steel beast neither moves nor responds to their presence in any way, the Russians are lured into believing it is abandoned and continue their advance.
Carius allows the Soviets to approach up to 60 meters before opening fire. As the first shot blows the turret off a T-34, the tank riders immediately leap off the vehicles into the nearest ditch, frantically searching for cover. The other tanks maneuver in disorder, desperately trying to escape the surprise attack of the ruthless Tiger as it reduces nine more tanks to scrap metal. Having lost 10 out of 12 tanks, the Russians are routed.

Did you know? *Otto Carius' gunner, Kramer Heinz, is the only tank crew member in history to have shot down a plane in flight with a tank gun. This Tiger's crew surely knew how to put that 88 mm gun to good use.*

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